

Campo Real Strategy:

1. Tee-shot strategy (most important)

Your best tee clubs (by reliability, not length)

Based on your TrackMan numbers, your safe window is 90–140 m.

Default tee club order

5-wood (140 m) → best overall tee club

Hybrid 4 (133 m)

3-wood ONLY on wide holes (128 m average suggests it's not longer but more risky)

☞ If a hole feels tight or downhill: Hybrid 4 or 5-wood, not 3-wood.

Never force distance. Campo Real punishes misses more than short shots.

2. Course management rule for Campo Real hills

Uphill shots

Add ½-1 club

Example: 130 m uphill → play like 140 m

Downhill shots

Take less club

Aim to land short of the green and let it release

Greens often sit above or below fairway level – landing short is your friend.

3. “Three-shot par-4” rule (your secret weapon)

Many par 4s will be par 5s for you – and that's perfectly fine.

Ideal par-4 plan

Tee: 5-wood or hybrid (130–140 m)

Lay-up: 8i–7i (90–100 m)

Approach: PW–9i (85–95 m)

This keeps:

No forced long irons

No rushed wedges

No downhill panic shots

4. Par-5 strategy (where you can score)

Treat all par 5s as three comfortable shots + wedge.

Example:

5-wood (140)

Hybrid (130)

7i or 8i (90-100)

SW / PW in

No hero shots. Boring golf = good score.

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6. Putting & short game rules (save 5-8 shots)

Lag putts first → forget the hole on anything over ~8 m

Uphill putts are gold → always aim to finish below the hole

If unsure: putt instead of chip (Campo Real greens allow it often)

7. December + rental clubs adjustments

Rental shafts may be stiffer/heavier

Expect 5-10 m less carry

Swing at 80-85% to keep balance on slopes

Re-calibrate on the range:

Find one club you trust for ~120-130 m (likely hybrid or 5-wood)

That becomes your “fairway finder”

8. Your personal “golden rules” for the round

Forward tees only

5-wood / hybrid off most tees

Lay up to 70-100 m

Middle of green > pin

Walk at your rhythm – don’t rush uphill

Decision making:

One simple adjustment that will help immediately
Back-9 tee rule (very important for you)

From hole 10 onwards:

Tee off at 80-85% swing

Choose the most reliable club, not the longest

Accept being short but in play

Short + straight beats long + tired every time.

Instead of total strokes, focus on:

- ☒ Staying calm on back-9 tees
- ☒ No blow-ups over 9 on one hole
- ☒ Enjoying the walk and scenery
- ☒ Finishing with energy left

The golden wind rule (memorise this)

When tired OR into wind → club DOWN, swing smooth

Specifically for you:

Into headwind:

Do NOT take a longer club

Take your 5i / hybrid and swing at 80%

Crosswind:

Avoid woods unless the hole is very wide

Aim into the wind, accept shorter distance

Downwind:

Woods are fine, but swing easy

(This alone can save 6-10 strokes in windy rounds.)

Tee decision checklist (10 seconds max)

Before every tee shot ask:

Am I tired?

Is there wind?

Is this hole narrow?

If any answer is YES →

👉 Hybrid or 5i, not wood.

One simple rule for Campo Real (write this on your glove)

Back 9 = boring golf

Hybrid / iron, middle of fairway, middle of green.

Do that and:

Tee shots stabilize

Fatigue matters less

Scores drop naturally

🧘 BACK-9 MANTRA (say it quietly)

Smooth swing. Short is fine. In play is perfect

📋 YOUR PERSONAL WIND DECISION TABLE

(Based on your real TrackMan distances + fatigue patterns)

OFF THE TEE

Condition	Club	Why
Calm/light breeze	5-wood (140 m)	Easy distance, smooth swing
Headwind	Hybrid 4 (133 m)	Lower flight, less spin
Crosswind	Hybrid 4 or 5i	Predictable curve
Downwind	5-wood (80% swing)	Wind gives free distance
Tired (any wind)	Hybrid 4	Best control-to-effort ratio
Narrow hole	Hybrid 4 or 5i	Fairway > distance

⊗ Avoid 3-5-wood in wind – too much height + dispersion for you right now.

APPROACH SHOTS (very important at Campo Real)

Situation	What to do
Uphill + wind	Add club, swing smooth
Downhill + wind	Club down, land short
Any doubt	Play for front/middle of green
Pin tucked	Ignore it (seriously)

📶 YOUR “EMERGENCY TEE CLUB”

👉 Hybrid 4 (133 m)

This is your safety blanket.

Use it when:

You feel rushed

You're tired

Wind is confusing

Hole looks scary

Back 9 pressure appears

Tell yourself:

“Hybrid in play beats wood in trouble.”

If you commit to this on holes 13-18, your score will stabilize.

🎯 ONE RULE THAT WILL SAVE YOU STROKES

Never change club because of ONE bad shot.

Change club only because of:

Wind

Fatigue

Hole shape

That's it.

If Ball is on the threes:

Your BEST decision framework (use this every time)

Step 1 – Ask ONE question

Can I advance the ball 60-100 m safely?

If yes → do that

If no → chip out sideways

Option A: GO LOWER (your default “smart” play)

Use this when:

You have a gap under branches

Trees are 20-80 m away

You don't need full distance

Best clubs for you:

5i

Hybrid 4 (choke down, 70-80% swing)

How to execute (simple)

Ball slightly back

Short finish

Smooth swing

Aim for fairway, not green

This advances the ball without drama and keeps your next shot easy.

2. Option B: GO SIDEWAYS (this is NOT failure)

Use this when:

Trees are very close

No clear gap

You'd have to swing hard

Miss = branches or worse

Smart play:

PW / 9i

Chip back to fairway

Leave yourself 90-110 m

This often saves 2-3 strokes compared to forcing it.

Your BUNKER DECISION RULE (remember this)

Hard sand = chip it, not splash it!

☒ Best club

SW (or PW if the lip is low)

🧠 Setup (simple)

Feet slightly open

Ball middle to slightly back

Weight 60-70% on front foot

Grip normal (do NOT open the face much)

🧐 ♀ Swing thought

“Pick it clean” (closed face) - Chipping

You are not splashing sand here.

When taking UNPLAYABLE is the BEST choice

Take an unplayable (1 penalty stroke) if:

Sand is hard/compact

Lip is high

Ball is close to the face

You feel tense or rushed

Why it's smart

Unplayable = +1 stroke

Two failed bunker shots = +2 or +3 strokes

Most high handicappers save 1-2 strokes by taking relief early.

When you SHOULD try to play it

Try the shot only if:

Sand is soft enough

You can open the face

You don't need a violent swing

You accept just “out is good”

How to try (only then):

Open face

Ball forward

Swing through the sand

Forget distance

our PERSONAL bunker rule (write this down)

One penalty is cheaper than two bunker shots!

Mental reset (this matters)

Calling a ball unplayable:

Is rules-smart

Shows good course management

Keeps your round alive

Prevents frustration carrying into next holes

It's what experienced golfers do – not beginners!

Bottom line for you:

Deep + hard sand = unplayable is often correct

Deep + soft sand = maybe try once

Never try twice